

Firearms Trace Data: Texas - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Texas in Calendar Year 2023

55,248

Firearm Types with a Texas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	43,633
Rifles	5,141
Revolvers	3,148
Shotguns	2,305
Machinegun Conversion Devices	364
Machineguns	246
Derringers	176
Receivers/Frames	135
Other*	100

* Other includes Unknown Types, Silencers, Combinations, Any Other Weapons, Destructive Devices and a Flare Gun.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a Texas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	27,127
.40 Cal	5,493
.380 Cal	3,674

.22 Cal	3,478
.45 Cal	3,079
12GA	1,774
.38 Cal	1,394
5.56mm	1,323
7.62mm	1,309
MULTI	927

NOTE: There were 4,703 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 967 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Texas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Weapon Offense	14,184
Firearm Under Investigation	9,590
Possession of Weapon	6,650
Found Firearm	5,439
Aggravated Assault	3,172
Dangerous Drugs	3,156
Carrying Prohibited Weapon	1,414
Health - Safety	1,168
Homicide	1,153
Weapons Trafficking	1,105

NOTE: There were 8,217 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a Texas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Texas	40,754
Louisiana	1,150
Oklahoma	497
Mississippi	486
Florida	450
Arkansas	361
Georgia	342
New Mexico	271
Alabama	269
California	251
Tennessee	243
Missouri	206
Arizona	202
Colorado	173
North Carolina	173

NOTE: An additional 35 states, Puerto Rico, U.S. Virgin Islands and Guam accounted for 2,102 other traces. The source state was identified in 47,930 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Texas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	4,277
3 Months to Under 7 Months	3,353
7 Months to Under 1 Year	3,528
1 Year to Under 2 Years	7,695
2 Years to Under 3 Years	6,650
3 Years and Over	22,345

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Texas Average Time-to-Crime: **5.76 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Texas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	1,460
18 to 21	4,522
22 to 24	3,876
25 to 30	5,912
31 to 40	6,587
41 to 50	3,804
Over 50	3,129

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Texas Average Age of Possessor: **33 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Texas Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Houston	12,586
San Antonio	6,300
Dallas	5,421
Fort Worth	1,631
Austin	1,456
Arlington	929
Lubbock	904
Corpus Christi	873
Mesquite	873
Amarillo	813

NOTE: There were 758 additional municipalities that accounted for 23,312 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 150 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Texas. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Texas.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a Texas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a Texas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a Texas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a Texas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a Texas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a Texas Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024